

Note making and Summary Writing

The meaning of the word 'note' is a 'brief written record as an aid to memory.' There are different types of notes depending upon the purpose. Different kinds of notes include concept ordering notes, revision notes, research notes, comparative notes and analytical notes. Notes generally summarize the reading and listening we have done.

Broadly, note making is a practice of jotting down important points, arguments, ideas and information contained in oral or written documents.

You should follow certain way to take notes. To prepare good notes following points should be taken into consideration.

- Read the text or listen to the oral document carefully
- identify key ideas
- Give suitable title to the text or presentation
- give subtitles where necessary
- find out the supporting details
- do not copy exact sentences you read or hear-use your own words to express the idea
- do not note in sentences-use phrases, omit helping verbs and pronouns
- never bring anything in your note that is not in the given text or presentation
- remove examples, explanations and less significant issues
- method of sequencing: numerals and letters

Summary writing

Summary writing is a process of condensing information without changing the original meaning and focus of the text. To write a summary, we should use our own words to express briefly the main idea and relevant details of the text.

Techniques of summary writing

Selection: select key ideas and supporting details

Rejection: unimportant details are rejected. Mostly following things are rejected:

- Repetition
- Examples
- Minor supporting details

Substitution: this includes combining sentences, sentence substitution and word substitution.

Read the following passage carefully, make notes and write a summary.

There is an enemy beneath our feet – an enemy deadlier for its complete impartiality. It recognizes no national boundaries, no political parties. Everyone in the world is threatened by it. The enemy is the earth itself. When an earthquake strikes, the world trembles. The power of a quake is always greater than anything human beings themselves can produce. Today scientists are directing a great deal of their efforts into finding some way of combating earthquakes, and it is possible that sometime in the near future people will have discovered a means of protecting themselves.

An earthquake strikes without warning. When it does, its power is immense. If it strikes a modern city, the damage it causes is as great as if it has struck a primitive village. Gas mines burst, explosions caused. Underground railways are wrecked. Whole buildings collapse, bridges fall, dams burst. Gaping crevices appear in busy streets. If a quake strikes at sea, huge tidal waves sweep island. If it strikes in mountain regions, avalanches roar down in to the valley.

Consider the terrifying statistics from the past. Lisbon, the capital of Portugal, was destroyed entirely and 450 people were killed in 1755. In Peru, fifty thousand people died in an earthquake in 1970. In 1968, an earthquake struck Alaska. As this is a relatively unpopulated part, only few people were killed. But this is likely that this was one of the most powerful quakes ever to have hit the world. Geologists estimate that during the tremors, the whole of the state moved ahead over eighty feet farther west in to the Pacific Ocean. Imagine the power of something that can move an entire subcontinent! This is the problem that faces scientists. They are dealing with forces so immense that human beings cannot hope to resist them. At least some precautionary measures can be taken to save lives and some of the property.

Title: Earthquake- An enemy beneath our feet

1. Earthquake: features
 - 1.1 impartial
 - 1.2 makes the world tremble
 - 1.3 Uncertain
 - 1.4 So much powerful
2. Damages done by earthquakes-in general
 - 2.1 Gas mines burst
 - 2.2 explosions caused
 - 2.3 Underground railways wrecked
 - 2.4 Whole buildings collapse
 - 2.5 bridges fall
 - 2.6 dams burst
 - 2.7 Gaping crevices appear
 - 2.8 avalanches roar
3. Damages done by earthquakes-in particular
 - 3.1 Lisbon-1755

- 3.1.1 city destroyed
 - 3.1.2 450 killed
 - 3.2 Peru-1970
 - 3.2.1 fifty thousand people died
 - 3.3 Alaska-1968
 - 3.3.1 Few people killed
 - 3.3.2 The most powerful quake ever
 - 3.3.3 State moved ahead for over eighty feet
- 4. Scientists' efforts
 - 4.1 suggest precautionary measures
 - 4.2 pinpoint earthquake prone areas

Read the following passage carefully, make notes and write a summary. 5+5=10

Plagiarism is the use of another person's ideas or expressions in your writing without acknowledging the source. The word comes from the Latin word 'plagiaries' and Alexander Lindsay defines it as, "the false assumption of authorship: the wrongful act of taking the product of another person's mind and presenting it as one's own." In short, to plagiarize is to give the impression that you have written or thought something that you have in fact borrowed from someone else, and to do so is considered a violation of the professional responsibility to acknowledge.

The most blatant form of plagiarism is reproducing someone else's sentences, more or less verbatim, and presenting them, as their own. Other forms include repeating another's particularly apt phrase without appropriate acknowledgement, paraphrasing someone else's argument as your own, introducing another's line of thinking as your own development of an idea and failing to cite the source for a borrowed thesis or approach. The penalties for plagiarism can be severe, ranging from loss of respect to loss of degrees, tenure, or even employment. At all stages research and writing, you must guard against the possibility of inadvertent plagiarism by keeping careful notes that distinguish between your own musings and thoughts and material you gather from others.

Even without considering the penalties of plagiarism, the best scholars generously acknowledge their debts to others. By doing so they not only contribute to the historiography of scholarship but also help younger scholars understand the process of research and discovery.

Title: Plagiarism

1. Plagiarism- an introduction
 - 1.1 copying other people's ideas without acknowledgement
 - 1.2 wrongful act of taking other people's ideas
 - 1.3 violation of the professional responsibility
2. Blatant forms of plagiarism
 - 2.1 reproducing someone else's sentences
 - 2.2 repeating other people's apt phrase
 - 2.3 paraphrasing someone else's argument
 - 2.4 fail to cite properly
3. The penalties for plagiarism
 - 3.1 loss of respect
 - 3.2 loss of degrees
 - 3.3 loss of job
4. Scholars' activities
 - 4.1 acknowledge the source
 - 4.2 teach young people the process of research

Read the following text carefully, prepare its notes and write a summary

Acupuncture is a system of treatment of disease which has been practiced in China for nearly 5000 years. It consists in the rapid insertion of fine steel needles, about six centimeters long, on particular spots on the

body of the patient. After inserting the needle, the doctor twirls the needle between his thumb and forefinger. There are hundreds of acupuncture points on the body. When acupuncture is made on a spot on the body, energy flows from there along line known as meridians to the diseased organ. The flow of energy helps to restore the balance of the system and thus correct the disorder. The points of treatment may be far from the seat of the disease. For example, to cure a toothache, the acupuncturist may insert a needle on the palm of the patient.

Although China is considered to be the country where acupuncture originated, some forms of treatment resembling it has been reported from other parts of the world by anthropologists. Among some ancient tribes, stones and arrows were used to prick the skin. In another form of treatment, the skin on particular spot of the body was burnt to affect a cure for certain diseases. Whether these kinds of treatment can rightly be classed with acupuncture can be known only after further research.

For long acupuncture was dismissed by the west as a form of superstition like witchcraft and magic cure. Even in China admiration for the western system of medicine was so great that the native systems of treatment were neglected or mistrusted. Moreover, the theoretical basis of acupuncture that was propounded in China was a mixture of spirituality, philosophy and physiology. This stood in the way of its acceptance by Chinese scientists.

During the 1960s acupuncture came to the notice of western scientists, who viewed it with skepticism as well as curiosity. Doctors from Europe went to China to make a firsthand study of this strange form of treatment. They were convinced by what they saw that acupuncture worked. Not only were diseases cured, but even operations were performed after administering anesthesia by acupuncture. The patient of such an operation could see and know what was being done, but felt no pain. After the operation, he could get up and walk away. Doctors in other parts of the world took acupuncture seriously and some of them trained themselves and set up practices in their countries. In China itself the status of acupuncture rose when Chinaman Mao officially ranked acupuncturist with other physicians